

BSc Business Management with Marketing with Industrial Placement and Integrated Foundation Year

Fashion, to me, has never been limited to aesthetics or trends. It represents identity, culture, and storytelling. Over time, I realized that while creativity shapes fashion, marketing gives it meaning by connecting products to people through narrative, positioning, and strategy. This understanding inspired me to pursue the BSc Business Management with Marketing with Industrial Placement and Integrated Foundation Year at the University of Birmingham Dubai, where I can strengthen both my academic foundation and practical understanding of global business and marketing.

My interest in this field developed early within my home environment. Observing my mother design and curate outfits showed me how fashion communicates individuality and emotion. At the same time, exposure to Shyam Garments, our family's retail business, introduced me to the commercial side of fashion. Conversations around customers, inventory, supplier relationships, and sales sparked my curiosity about how businesses operate, adapt, and grow. During my internship there in Class 11, I worked on Instagram promotions, merchandising, and campaign execution. I also observed pricing decisions, vendor negotiations, and sourcing processes, which helped me understand how branding and operational choices influence customer perception and profitability.

Academically, my study of business, economics, and psychology strengthened my interest in management and marketing. Economics introduced me to concepts such as market structures, competition, and consumer behavior, while psychology helped me understand perception, motivation, and decision-making. These interests came together in my Grade 12 Business Studies project, where I created a complete marketing plan involving market research, branding, segmentation, competitor analysis, and promotional strategy. The experience reinforced my understanding of marketing as a field that combines analytical thinking with creativity and communication.

Beyond academics, I applied these concepts through practical experiences. I led promotional initiatives for school events such as Yujan and TEDx, where I worked on branding, content creation, and audience engagement strategies. These experiences taught me how effective communication and visual identity can influence participation and perception while strengthening my teamwork, adaptability, and organizational skills.

My entrepreneurial experiences further deepened my interest in business management and marketing. Through Teen Interns, I launched an online thrift store focused on sustainable fashion, where I managed sourcing, digital marketing, and customer engagement. I also created an Etsy store selling digital templates and posters, independently handling product design, SEO optimization, pricing, and analytics. The store achieved over 200 sales within three months, allowing me to evaluate customer behavior, track performance metrics, and refine my marketing strategy. In addition, my internship with bridal designer Reeti Arneja

exposed me to luxury branding and consumer experience. I contributed to social media campaigns, coordinated shoots, and managed logistics, gaining insight into how storytelling, heritage, and exclusivity shape consumer loyalty in the luxury fashion sector.

While these experiences provided valuable exposure, they also highlighted my need for formal academic training in management principles, marketing analytics, consumer insights, and strategic decision-making. The integrated foundation year particularly appeals to me because it will help me strengthen my academic readiness while adapting to the rigor of an international learning environment.

The University of Birmingham Dubai is the ideal place for me because of its balance between theoretical learning and practical exposure. I am particularly drawn to the industrial placement opportunity, which will allow me to apply classroom knowledge in a professional setting while gaining international work experience. Studying in Dubai also offers exposure to one of the world's most globally connected business environments, where international brands, innovation, and multicultural consumer markets intersect.

After completing the program, I aim to work in marketing or retail strategy roles within organizations such as Zara or Reliance Luxury to deepen my understanding of branding, consumer insights, and digital marketing. In the long term, I aspire to work with global luxury groups such as LVMH and eventually build my own fashion-focused business venture that combines creativity with strategic management.

I believe my academic background, entrepreneurial experiences, and passion for the intersection of creativity and business make me well-suited for this program. I look forward to contributing to the University of Birmingham Dubai while developing the skills and global perspective required for a meaningful career in business and marketing.